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Why is making money bad?

1 message

Candid insights <noreply@send.candid.org> Thu, Jul 23, 2026 at 6:07 AM
Reply-To: Candid insights <reply-IYAWGCJZP4IE5D6EQTNEZCJATM.100229@send.candid.org>
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Let's talk about the catch-22 of nonprofit funding. We all need money to survive, but so many of us shy away from charging reasonable fees for our programs and services. That revenue could be transformative for financial stability. So why do we hesitate?

At Candid, nearly 80% of our funding is earned revenue. That gives us the freedom to constantly reinvest in our data and products to better meet the sector's needs. To balance fees with access, we work with partners like libraries and universities to offer Candid to their communities for free. We also provide free access to Candid Premium to nonprofits with annual revenue or expenses under $1 million when they earn a Gold Seal of Transparency or higher.

Here's the thing: relying on one funding source is a gamble, whether that's individual donations or foundation grants (which, by the way, most small nonprofits can't access). You do great work. Great work deserves to be paid for, and it deserves the kind of financial stability that lets you actually plan instead of just survive.

Set aside some time this summer to get creative about what earned revenue could look like for your organization. We'd love to hear your ideas on LinkedIn.



Aleda Gagarin
Vice President of Influence, Candid

Featured article

Demystifying nonprofit earned income

From Goodwill stores, museum admissions and gift shops, theater and concert tickets, to college tuition, earned income makes up 71% of nonprofit revenue. These funds help nonprofits remain financially stable, yet many people believe public charities can't (or shouldn't) charge for products or services.

This myth gets in the way of nonprofits bringing in the money they need to pay for things like staff to run programs, rent, and equipment. But you can prove it wrong. Explain how this income supports your work, and be open about your numbers.

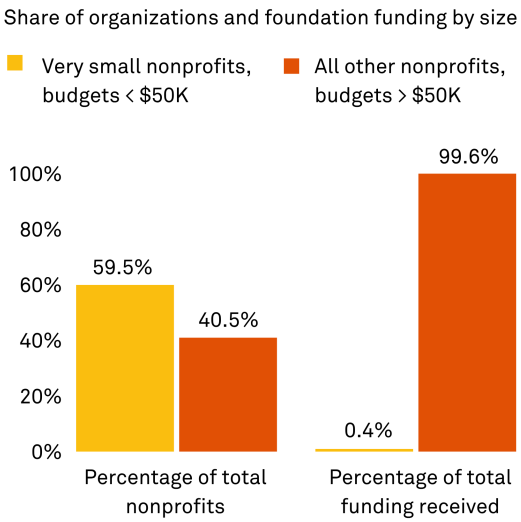
Get the facts

Featured data

Getting funding for small nonprofits

Over half of U.S. nonprofits are very small organizations that run on less than $50,000 a year. They're doing essential work, yet they only get about 0.4% of foundation funding. Learn more about Candid's data on small nonprofits, the barriers they face, and how they fundraise.

Dive into data



More from Candid insights

The best grant writers know how to get funders' attention

Crafting a stand-out grant proposal requires telling a compelling story. And the key is connecting with your audience. Learn how to grab a funder's attention, tell your unique story, and build a real connection.

Get the tips

Free community access to Candid

Whether you're looking for grant opportunities or want to learn more about the nonprofits in your community, you can access Candid for free at nearly 2,200 partner locations.

Learn more

A 'whole person' approach to preventing burnout

> One nonprofit is tackling staff burnout by providing various types of support to their team. That means helping them stay connected to the mission, while also offering wellness programs for physical, mental, and financial health, and flexible schedules.
>
> Find out how

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